NEW MEXICO STATE UNIVERSITY

theRound UpWeekly

A NEW MEXICO STATE STUDENT MEDIA ORGANIZATION | THURSDAY, OCTOBER 27, 2011 | VOL. 113 NO. 11 | ROUNDUPDAILY.COM

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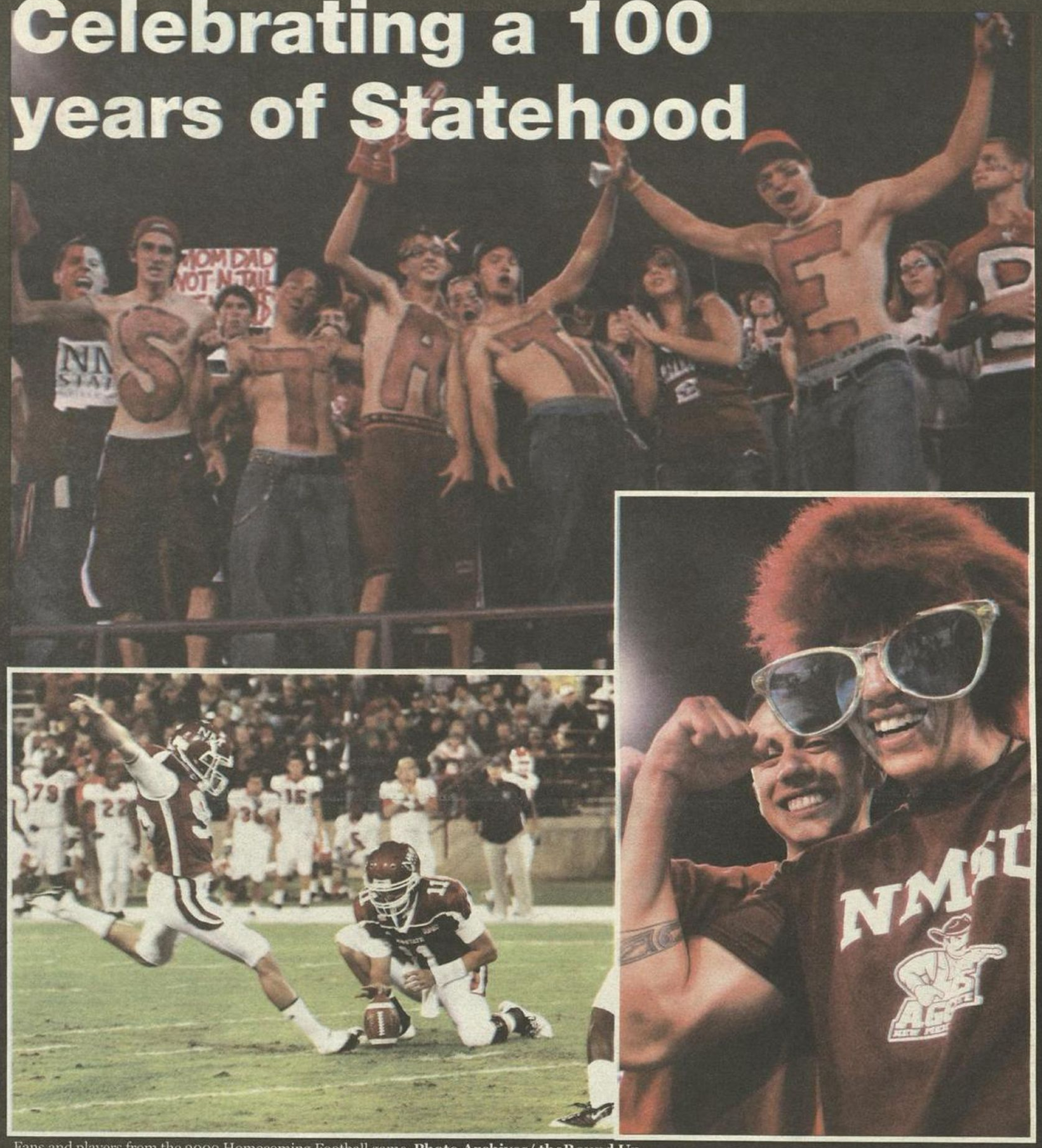
Celebrating a 100 years of Statehood



Fans and players from the 2009 Homecoming Football game. **Photo Archives/ theRound Up**

Homecoming and its traditions at New Mexico State University

By Trevor Nazario and Anthony Ruff | Staff Writers

The New Mexico State University campus is gearing up for Homecoming this weekend, but many students are not even aware what Homecoming is.

"I think it's a dance of some sort celebrating a football game," CMI major at NMSU Scott Corigan said. "I haven't seen any advertising. I had no clue this was happening and why now? Isn't it almost Halloween?"

"I have no clue what goes on," NMSU student Sasha Maroon said. "I didn't even know we had Homecoming."

"I didn't know about [Homecoming], but I don't really care," Erin McClure, theatre arts major said. "It's just a football game. We usually lose anyways."

Homecoming is a tradition at NMSU, which is put on so that past and new students may come together and celebrate their Aggie pride. Homecoming is the tradition of welcoming back alumni to the school.

The theme for Homecoming this year is celebrating "100 Years of Statehood" for New Mexico. There are reunion dinners for the classes of 1951, 9161, and 1981 during the week.

Although it seems the majority of NMSU students either do not know about Homecoming or do not care, ASNMSU is trying to spread the word through events.

"Homecoming is for students that have graduated to come back," Director of Activities at ASNMSU Maria Ration said. "Alumni and current students come together and show off their Aggie pride. It's when past students come home."

Homecoming week is a chain of events ASNMSU puts on to advertise and celebrate Homecoming.

During Homecoming week, various colleges hold receptions and honor distinguished alumni. During the week, the movie "Hangover 2" was shown in Aggie Memorial Stadium on Tuesday night for Movie Night on the Green.

Upcoming events include a bonfire, pep rally and concert at 7 p.m Thursday Oct. 26.

The Homecoming parade on Friday Oct. 29 will span from the Pan American Center to Knox Street starting at 10 a.m

Trevor Nazario and Anthony Ruff are staff writers and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

EVENTS THIS WEEK

OCT 27-28 DOOR DECORATING CONTEST
This year's theme is "CELEBRATE WITH US NEW MEXICO STATEHOOD". Faculty and staff are encouraged to enter our door-decorating contest. There will be 1st, 2nd and 3rd place winners for the door decorating contest.

OCT. 27 BONFIRE & CONCERT
Bonfire and Concert on Thursday, October 27 at 7:00pm in Tailgate Lot. Come out and watch Love and Theft.

OCT. 27 REUNION DINNERS
Reunion dinners will be held at 6 p.m. Thursday for the class of 1951, at La Posta de Mesilla and 6 p.m. Thursday for the class of 1961 at 6 p.m. at Corbett Center's West Ballroom. The reunion dinner for the 1981 class will be held at 6 p.m. Thursday at My Brother's Place restaurant.

OCT. 28 CRIMSON DAY
Students spotted wearing crimson gear will be given prizes, including T-shirts, footballs and key chains in celebration of Crimson Day on Friday on the NMSU campus.

OCT. 29 PARADE & FOOTBALL GAME
10 a.m. Saturday, the parade starts and runs along University St. 6 p.m. Homecoming Football Game - NMSU Aggies vs. Nevada

FROM THE *EDITOR*

This weekend marks Homecoming week at New Mexico State University. The event itself celebrates the gathering of past and present students and overall Aggie pride.

As you read the front-page story of this week's Round Up, you will see many students are still unaware of what Homecoming really is and what it means. However, Greek Life at NMSU takes a large part in the Homecoming celebration and also spends a large amount in joining the event.

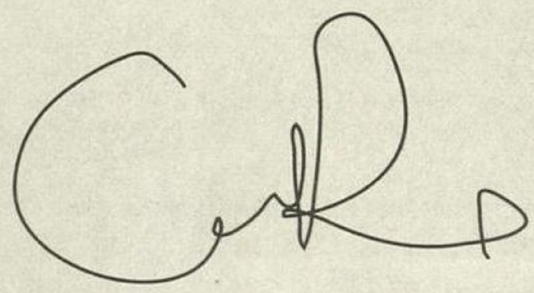
Every year Greek fraternities and sororities spend thousands decorating a float featured in the annual Homecoming parade, though this year, two Greek organizations decided to use their Homecoming funds in a different way.

Sigma Chi and Delta Zeta decided to spend less money on the float and more on the community. Instead of crafting a thousand-dollar presentation, the organizations have decided to make a simple float and donate the rest of the funds to Big Brothers and Big Sisters of Las Cruces.

Although there may be critics, especially other Greek organizations, we commend Sigma Chi and Delta Zeta. Rather than spending money on projects that end up in the trash, they are instead giving back to the Las Cruces community.

As Homecoming celebrates the coming together of current students and alumnus, what better way to show the pride and spirit of NMSU than assisting the community.

The Round Up would like to wish all students and NMSU community members a safe and happy Homecoming, and as always, go Aggies!



-Cassandra Romero

PHOTOS OF THE WEEK

Three of the doors decorated for the Homecoming door decorating competition. **Erynn McConnell & Zane Klemo / theRoundUp**

theRound Up*Weekly*

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Obama proposes 'Pay As You Earn'

By Francesca Bessey | UWIRE

The Obama administration announced Tuesday it is proceeding with a new "Pay As You Earn" proposal that would reduce monthly payments for more than 1.5 million college students who currently owe money on student loans.

The proposal will cap college students' monthly loan payments at 10 percent of their discretionary income. Students would also be forgiven the balance of their debt after 20 years of payments.

This is an expedited version of a measure planned for 2014 in which all borrowers will be able to similarly reduce their payments.

Current law limits borrowers' payments to 15 percent of their discretionary income and forgives remaining debt after 25 years of consistent payments.

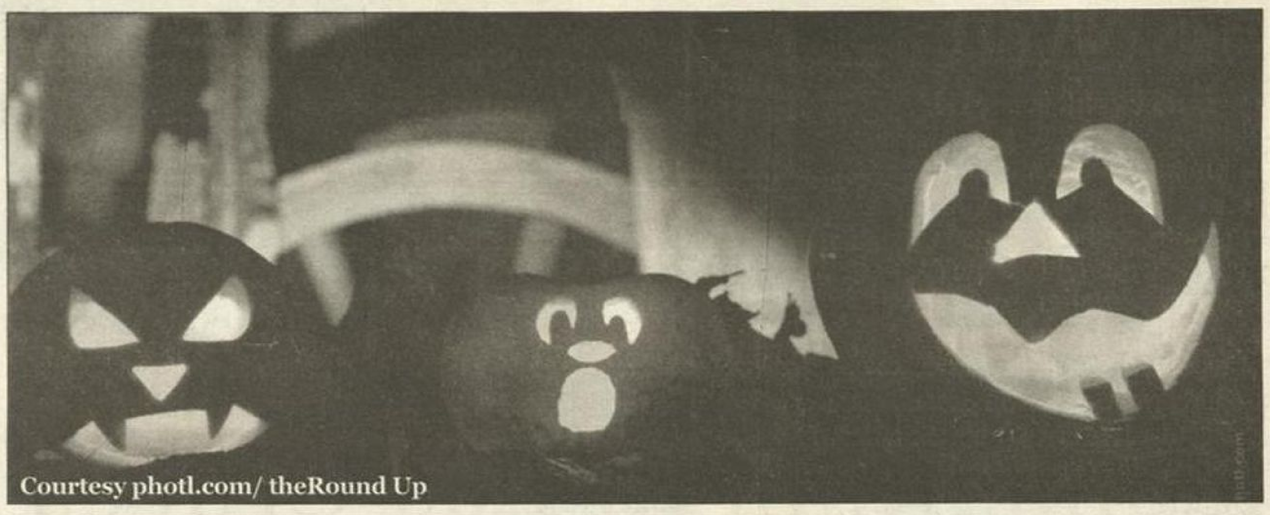
"In a global economy, putting a college education within reach for every American has never been more important," President Barack Obama said, regarding the proposal. "But it's also never been more expensive. That's why today we're taking steps to help."

Additional measures are also being taken to improve the way

See Pay as You Earn pg. 6

Halloween brings in more than just Trick-or-Treating

By Jessica Cervantes | Staff Writer



Courtesy photl.com/ theRound Up

Halloween is not just trick-or-treating these days.

New Mexico State University and the city of Las Cruces will host numerous events for all ages in celebration of the spooky holiday with events ranging from zombie walks to haunted houses.

Several NMSU clubs are taking part in frightening the community in order to support the Las Cruces High School Theatre Booster Club through the "Asylum Project" haunted house. The haunted house is free to all who are willing to have a good scare in the creative project.

Public Relations Director and sophomore business major Isabella Lucero encourages all citizens to dare to enter the haunted house because it is free, fun and for a good cause.

"The best part of working on the Asylum Project was that we got to collaborate with so many creative, innovative and talented people to produce an amazing, terrifying experience for the public," Lucero said.

The haunted house will be open on Oct. 30 and 31 from 6 p.m. to 11 p.m. at 2716 Cheyenne Drive.

As for zombies, all participants will congregate in front of the Rio Grande Theatre at 211 N. Main Street at 5:45 p.m. on Saturday, Oct. 28 for the second annual Las Cruces Zombie Walk. The free event will end in a dance party in front of the theatre featuring band, The Phuzz.

Sophomore nursing major Michael Duran said he plans on attending the Zombie Walk this year.

"I heard a lot of really great things about the first one last year," Duran said. "I'm looking forward to dressing up with a ton of Halloween make-up and getting to see what everyone else is wearing."

Barnes and Noble is offering students the chance to win the ultimate Halloween treat bag by submitting a picture in their craziest, best or most outrageous costume. "Liking" the Barnes and Noble Facebook page will allow contestants to enter the Paranormal Apparel Facebook Contest.

There will be two separate walk/runs at NMSU hosted by NMSU Army ROTC and the Kinesiology club. The annual Community Food Bank Halloween Run will start Friday, Oct. 28 at 6:30 a.m., and will be raising canned good donations for the Community Action Agency of Southern New Mexico Food Bank. The Kinesiology club will start their run at O'Donnell Hall at 9 a.m. Sunday, Oct. 30.

Housing and Residential Life will also be hosting games, food and fun for the Student Family Housing Halloween Extravaganza on Oct. 30 from 4 p.m. to 7 p.m. at the Activity Center.

The cultural event Día de los Muertos will be celebrated in Mesilla with arts and crafts, altars, food vendors, entertainment and dancing starting Friday, Oct. 28 from 5.p.m. to 8 p.m. and running on Saturday and Sunday from 6 p.m. to 10 p.m.

For other upcoming Halloween events at NMSU, check out calendar.nmsu.edu.

Jessica Cervantes is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

Center for the Arts pays tribute to professor and wife

By Jose Salayandia | Staff Writer

New Mexico State University Center for the Arts, scheduled to open in the fall of 2012, will pay tribute to a professor and his wife for their contributuions to students and the community.

Mark and Stephanie Medoff are well known at New Mexico State University and surrounding areas due to their many contributions to the university and the education of many students.

Christa Slaton, dean of the College of Arts and Sciences, nominated the Medoffs for the honor and said her recommendation came after broad consultation across the university campus and throughout the community.

"No one talks about the theatre at NMSU without referencing Mark and Stephanie Medoff and their 40-year contributions to this campus and community," Slaton said. "We are extraordinarily lucky on this campus to have a Tony-Award winning playwright and Oscar-nominated screenwriter remain with us to teach our students, mentor our faculty and bring exceptional talent to our university. I am delighted that our beautiful new theatre will honor their legacy."

Mark Medoff's mentorship has been instrumental in many students' journeys at NMSU, which has even extended beyond when he assisted students as they transitioned from school and into professional careers. The Medoffs have donated nearly half a million dollars to establish endowments for student scholarships and to support other programs across campus.

The Center for the Arts building in process on the corner of Espina and University. **Erynn McConnell / theRoundUp**

He has continued supporting the growth of NMSU's theatre arts program since his arrival in 1966. He co-founded the American Southwest Theatre Company with the Bruce Streett in 1981 and is also an Oscar-nominated screenwriter and Tony Award-winning playwright. With a resume including over 28 plays and 12 screenplays, Medoff became a household name in NMSU's art department and still continues teaching at NMSU.

"To be recognized as part of the NMSU legacy honors not only the Medoff family, but everyone who has touched our lives," Mark Medoff said in a press release.

Mark Medoff said he never expected to be here so long and make it this far.

"I was 26 when I arrived here. I knew no one. I was going to stay a year," Medoff said in a press relase. "Forty-four years, three daughters and sons-in law and six grandchildren later, it's fair to say the vast majority of my friends and students passed through this city and university and helped to define me as a teacher and an artist. "

"The Medoffs have made a lasting imprint on the arts in our region and it is fitting that we honor their dedication and talents," Couture said in a press release. "NMSU's Department of Theatre Arts and the Creative Media Institute would not be what they are without Mark's perseverance and talent. He has made a difference to so many students whose lives he has touched."

The NMSU Center for the Arts was designed to bring together all of the arts programs on campus into one location. It will include the theater, free space and dance support areas.

The construction of the Center for the Arts is a multi-phase project and the first phase is expected to be completed in November 2012. It consists of a three-story facility approximately 59,000 square feet in size.

NMSU president Barbara Couture said the Medoffs have made a difference in many people's lives.

Jose Salayandia is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

Couture addresses university

By Jessica Cervantes | Staff Writer

New Mexico State University President Barbara Couture delivered the first State of the University address Oct. 19 at the Atkinson Hall to administrators, faculty and students.

In the "Progress Toward a New Era of Excellence through Partnership" speech, Couture addressed the failure to raise revenue in the state, which caused a budget cut, but also addressed the improvement strategies of the "Living the Vision" plan.

"Since 2009 alone, we lost $35 million across our university system, a move that resulted in our having to raise tuition by nearly 8 percent on the Las Cruces campus," Couture said.

Regents, however, approved a budget recommendation proposed by Couture that dedicated half a million dollars for new faculty for the main campus and another half a million to increase salaries of professors who have "demonstrated their excellence."

Couture said two of the main strategies are aimed at the completion of courses and essentially graduation in which changes to online programs will be made.

The Efficiency and Effectiveness Committee suggested projects such as improving bookstore processes to reduce book costs and service. The student senate is currently working with Barnes and Noble for this to take

See Address pg. 6

NMSU students join occupy movement in Las Cruces. **Gabriella Ferrari/ theRound Up**

Occupy Wall Street gains momentum in Las Cruces

By Grace Gutierrez | Staff Writer

The Occupy Wall Street movement has a large message and, regardless of individual support, the movement is growing.

"We are in solidarity with the global occupancy movement. We are here to inform and empower the people. We are working against corruption to find cooperative solutions as a community. We challenge systems that compromise (access to) basic human needs," According to Occupy Las Cruces on Facebook.

Many people are fighting for different things in the movement and there have been signs of all types spreading all kinds of messages.

According to occupywallstreet.org, "we can no longer afford to let corporate greed and corrupt politics set the policies of our nation."

However, there is one overlying theme: the 99 percent wants to take down the one percent and make them equals.

According to washingtonpost.com, the 99 percent is the majority of the people who make under $500,000 per year and want to have equality.

"Americans have a right to protest on public land," freshman geology major Cesar Soria said.

While some support the movement, others find it irritating.

"Some of the issues that they are protesting are actual issues," John Gariano, freshman engineering major, said, "but I dislike the fact that they are against big businesses, but are going to stores like Walmart and Albertsons to get products. They are hurting their own protest."

The movement, which began on Wall Street, has been mobilized, and there are now protestors in more than 2100 communities across the globe.

"The occupation is no longer just in New York," Soria said. "It's in California, New Mexico, China, Japan, and it shows no sign slowing down."

The movement is growing in every way. There are many groups springing up from the movement: Occupy Together, Occupy Colleges, Parents for Occupy Wall St. The 99 percent are all large scale groups that have formed because of the Occupy Wall Street movement. Many more local ones, such as Occupy Las Cruces, have started also.

Many discussion boards are filled with thoughts and opinions about Occupy Wall Street, and many more people are letting their opinions be known in other ways.

"The protests online [are most efficient]," Gariano said. "It is still broad on what they are trying to do, but it helps to bring in the support of other people allowing the other forms of protest to gain momentum."

Cartoons, videos, pictures and other posts have made the movement even more popular. The protests can be found everywhere as they continue to grow.

Grace Gutierrez is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

T. Bear Larson, Vulture flight test director for DARPA, gives a presentation on the Vulture unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) program during a research rally at O'Donnell Hall on the New Mexico State University campus. **Photo by Darren Phillips/ NMSU**

NMSU receives contract to test unmanned aircraft

By Allison Duarte | Staff Writer

The New Mexico State University Physical Science Laboratory was recently awarded a contract by the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency to help develop and test an unmanned aircraft.

According to NMSU News Center, the Vulture II program involves the testing of these unusual and unmanned aircrafts with a 1,000-pound payload and 400-foot wingspan. The Vulture is also able to be airborne for over five years.

"We are the only flight test center in the U.S. with a Cooperative Research Development Agreement from the Federal Aviation Administration," Deputy Director and Vulture Program manager at NMSU, Dave May, said. "Because of the aviation agreement, this air worthiness process was blessed by the FAA. It's an ongoing relationship that DARPA felt would be best for this aircraft."

Along with NMSU research agreement with the Federal Aviation Administration, the airspace around Las Cruces has low congestion making it an ideal flight test center. White Sands Missile Range serves as a block, giving limited access for aviation activity.

With this magnitude of a contract, NMSU will be benefitting immensely, aiding in exposing the physical science sect to the public.

"It will be helpful for getting the physical science lab out there and show our capabilities," May said.

Not only will the contract offer NMSU coverage, but it will also provides opportunity for additional contracts.

The first phase of the Vulture II program has been completed and phase two is still in the works. The Vulture II is multi-million dollar, highly publicized project, though there are still significant expenses.

"With temporary hangars and test site preparations, it's not like NMSU will be rolling in the bucks," said May.

The hangars and launch site are located just 15 miles outside of Las Cruces at the NMSU Jornada experimental range.

Plans call for actual flight testing in 2014, with the main focus centering on air-worthiness.

Doug Davis, the deputy director of technical analysis and application at the NMSU physical science lab, said Boeing designed the SolarEagle aircraft selected for the Vulture II program, according to the Albuquerque Journal.

NMSU president Barbara Couture said the project will offer vast opportunity for the university in an NMSU College of Business press release.

"It's quite an extraordinary accomplishment that's going to bring plenty of attention to New Mexico State University," Couture said.

Allison Duarte is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

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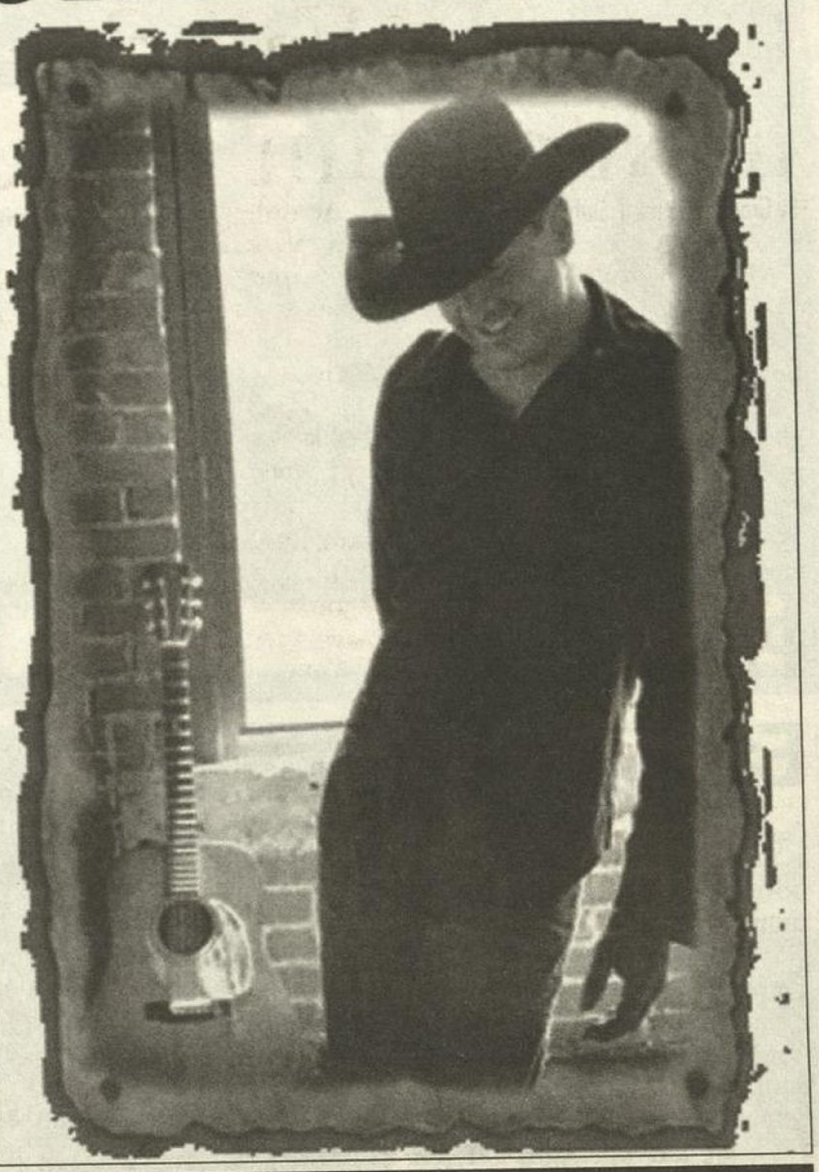

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Graham Central Station

Courtesy photl.com/ theRound Up

Pay as You Earn

Continued from P. 3

borrowers can manage their money.

As part of the Know Before You Owe project, the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau released Monday a Financial Aid Shopping Sheet. This sheet will help students easily compare financial aid packages offered by different institutions. It also makes the total long-term costs of student loans clear to students before they choose to enroll at a specific college.

The United States Small Business Administration and the Young Entrepreneur Council, meanwhile, have each launched programs to help young entrepreneurs with their federal student loan obligations.

The YEC will invest $10 million to pay the remaining student loan obligations of young entrepreneurs across the country.

Pay As You Earn is part of a larger series of executive actions to strengthen the American economy, Obama said.

If you have any comments please contact truprint@nmsu.edu

Address

Continued from P. 3

effect.

"Drop and Add" policies will be improved in order to encourage students to meet graduation requirements and promote graduation.

Couture also said the critical value of increasing alumni participation due to the fact NMSU has 36 chapters in the U.S.

"We are being driven to actively engage with public schools to boost their equality, make state public education more affordable, help adults get a college degree and increase degree holders in fields that prepare students for a changing job market," Couture said.

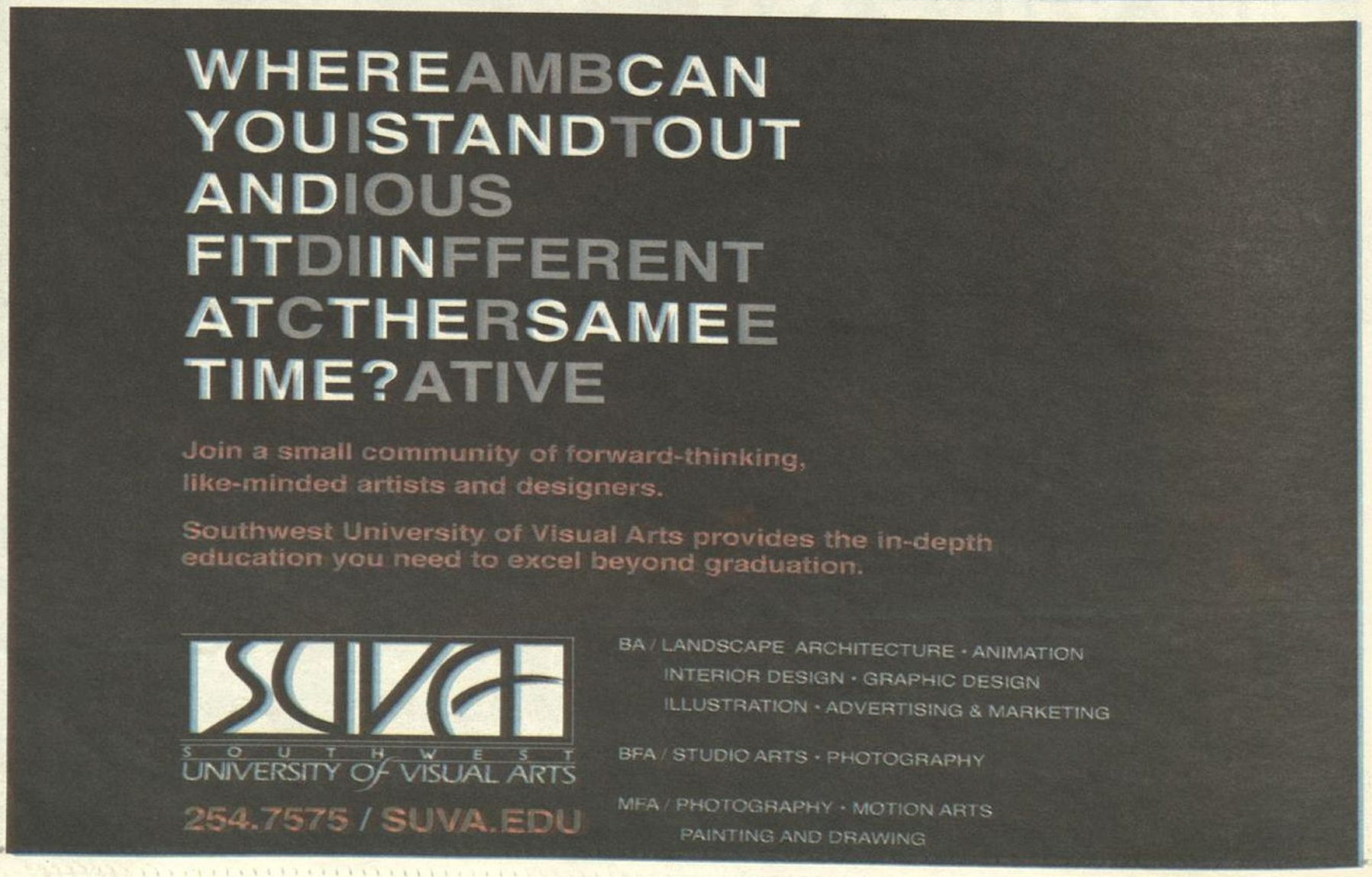
University progress and achievements were highlighted by the increase in rankings of notary magazines, two WAC championships and grants.

All campuses have received new facilities and improvements that are energy efficient and sustainable as well.

Couture also said progress is still being made to diversify the campus, create more alumni participation, raise research and economic development, extend international reach and build campus pride.

"There is no glue that better unites our efforts in all these areas than our dedication to excellent teaching," Couture said.

Jessica Cervantes is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu



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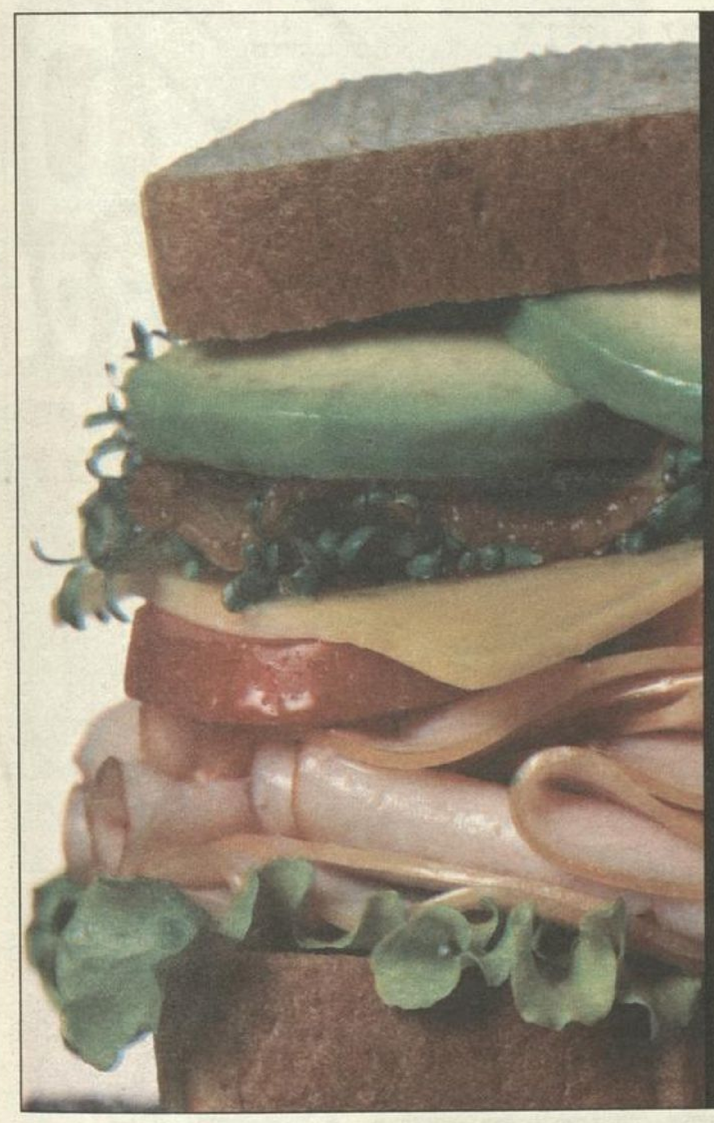

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	1		8		6			9
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		2						4
7	5	4	3					8
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	2		7				1	
		5		1		6	3	
3					9			

answers

2	8	4	9	5	6	1	7	3
7	3	9	8	1	2	5	4	6
5	1	6	3	4	7	9	2	8
6	2	5	4	7	9	8	3	1
8	9	1	2	6	3	4	5	7
4	7	3	5	8	1	2	9	6
3	5	8	1	9	4	7	6	2
9	4	7	6	2	8	3	1	5
1	6	2	7	3	5	6	8	4

Down Syndrome Awareness Month

October is Down Syndrome Awareness Month.
Join the Southern New Mexico Down Syndrome Families "Buddy Walk" this month. Details at www.snmdsf.org.

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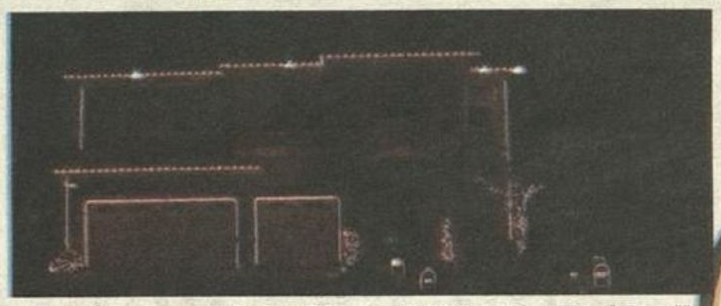
Viral Vids of the Week



"Halloween Light Show 2010 HD - Thriller "
By KJ92508

"David Calvo juggles and solves Rubik's Cubes"
By rastarubik

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3. "Era Extrana" By NEON INDIAN
4. "Strange Mercy" By ST. VINCENT
5. "Wild Flag" By WILD FLAG

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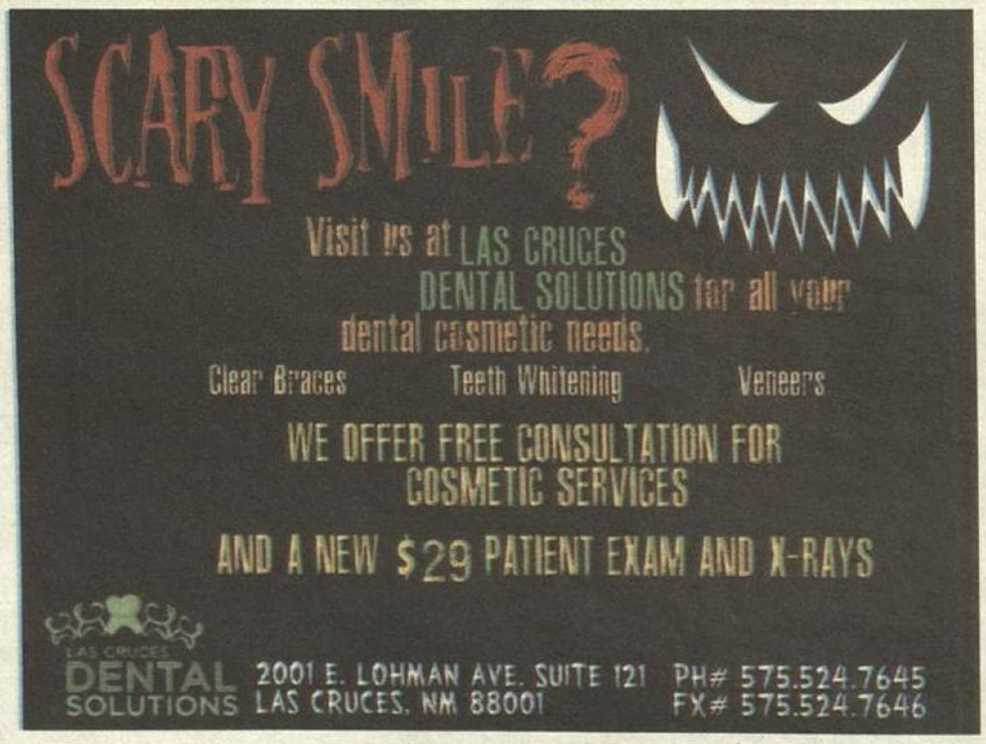

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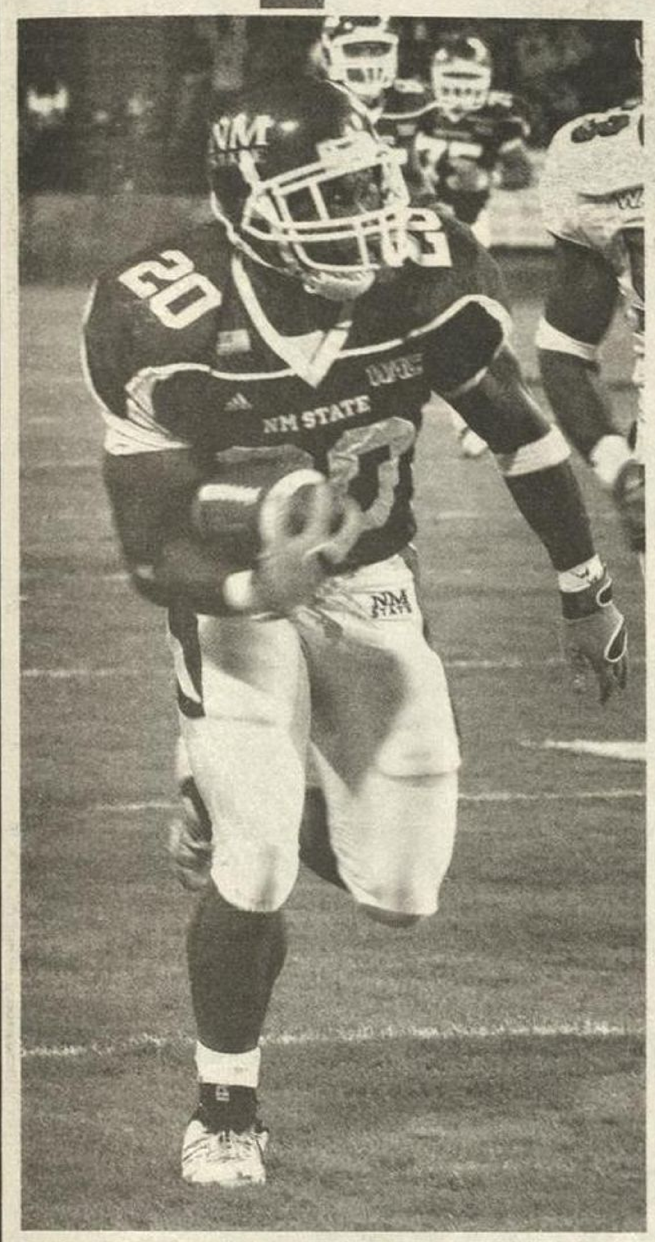
Sports

THIS WEEK IN SPORTS:

Soccer: vs. Hawai'i
Friday Oct. 28, Aggie Memorial Stadium 7 p.m.
Swimming: vs. Northern Colorado
Saturday Oct. 29, Aggie Natatorium 12 p.m.
Football: vs. Nevada
Saturday Oct. 29, Aggie Memorial Stadium 6 p.m.



NMSU Homecoming Football game 2010. **Photo Archives/ theRound Up**

Aggies face Wolf Pack for last time as WAC foes

By Anthony Exparza | Staff Writer

The New Mexico State football team will face Nevada for the final time as a Western Athletic Conference opponent when the Wolf Pack visit Las Cruces Saturday.

Nevada, along with Fresno State, will join the Mountain West Conference at the conclusion of the season. The two teams have met six times as members of the WAC and 14 times overall. The Wolf Pack is 12-2 against the Aggies and has never lost at Aggie Memorial Stadium.

Nevada defeated NM State last season 52-6 in Reno, Nev. However, NM State coach DeWayne Walker said the Aggies are much improved since their meeting with the Wolf Pack a year ago.

"It's another big challenge for us, "Walker said, of facing the Wolf Pack Saturday. "But I know we have a better football team than last year, so we're looking forward to it."

Nevada coach Chris Ault also said the Aggies have improved from last season and is expecting a more competitive game offensively.

"You look at the tape and see every week they get better and better something," Ault said of the Aggies. "Anytime you put 35 points up on Hawai'i over there, you're doing something right. We know we're going to have our hands full and looking forward to the game."

Nevada defeated Fresno State 45-38 on Oct. 22, improving its overall record to 4-3 and conference record to 2-0. The Aggies were defeated by Hawai'i 45-34, falling to 3-4 overall and 1-2 in WAC play.

The offensive battle will be between the NM State passing game and the Nevada rushing attack. The Aggies rank 30th in the country in pass yards per game with 273.1. The Wolf Pack rank 10th in rushing yards per game with 251.6.

However, the Aggie and Wolf Pack running attacks have also been productive this season. NM State junior running back Kenny Turner has ran for over 100 yards in four consecutive games. Nevada junior running back Mike Ball is averaging over 100 rushing yards per game.

All these offensive statistics could mean points may be at a premium when the Aggies and Wolf Pack meet in Las Cruces for the final time as WAC opponents Saturday night.

Follow Anthony Esparza on Twitter.com at @trusportsnmsu

NMSU Center Tshilidzi Nephawe goes for the lay-up during the NMSU vs. Hawaii basketball game last season. **Photo Archives / theRound Up**

Road to Redemption

Men's basketball looks to rebound from last season

By Anthony Esparza | Staff Writer

After an injury-plagued 2010-11 season in which the New Mexico State men's basketball team finished with more losses than wins for the first time in six seasons, the Aggies begin their quest to return to the NCAA Tournament on Nov. 12 against Northern Colorado.

This year's Aggies will look to rebound from a year ago when the team finished with a 16-17 record losing to Boise State in the semifinals of the Western Athletic Conference Tournament. Entering his fifth year, NM State coach Marvin Menzies said he is excited about the team's potential, but heedful.

"You're always cautiously optimistic going into a season, but at the end of the day, we have to go out there and produce," Menizes told NMStatesports.com. "That's the challenge: putting all the pieces together to realize our expectations."

If there was one positive to take away from last season, it was the valuable game experience the underclassmen received because of injuries to their teammates. Guard Christian Kabongo, forward Renaldo Dixon and center Tshilidzi Nephawe all played as freshmen last year.

After missing all of last season with a broken foot, Senior forward Wendell McKines will return this season.

"I think this team will be more physical and take pride in the little things that win basketball games," McKines said of the Aggies' style of play, "like rebounding, getting stops when necessary and playing more as a team than individuals."

The freshmen class this season consists of eight players from three countries including Las Cruces native Terrel de Rouen. The upperclassmen said they understand the trials and tribulations that come with being a freshman and are prepared to assist their new teammates.

"I'm going to help out the freshmen and tell them how it is," said senior center Hamidu Rahman. "Sometime you're going to go through your ups and downs, but you've just got to play through it."

In addition to the eight freshmen, the 2011-2012 Aggie roster is made up of four sophomores, three juniors and three seniors. The Aggie freshmen will benefit from the experience of the upperclassmen, especially since the team has back-to-back rivalry games early in the season.

After starting the season on the road against Northern Colorado, the Aggies travel to Albuquerque to face New Mexico on Nov. 16. The team then returns to Las Cruces to host the University of Texas El Paso on Nov. 19.

With the opening tipoff to the new year only a few weeks away, the Aggies anticipate the upcoming season.

"We have a positive mindset and we want to play hard every time," said senior point guard Hernst Laroche. "We want to do the right thing and be focused all the time. That's our main focus for this year."

Two leading players from last season not returning for the 2011-12 campaign are Gordo Castillo and Troy Gillenwater. Castillo graduated after last season, while Gillenwater decided to forego his senior season to declare for the NBA Draft. Castillo signed a deal to play for Fuerza Regia, a team from a Mexican professional league. Gillenwater now plays professionally in the European Cyprus league.

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MICHAEL HART

NMSU SENIOR WINS DUKE CITY MARATHON

Cody Johnson | Contributing Writer

A New Mexico State University cross-country runner placed first overall with a time of 2:41:18 in the Duke City Marathon in Albuquerque, N.M., on Sunday, Oct. 23.

Senior Michael Hart ran the full marathon, stretching a distance of 26.2 miles. Hart received a medal for his first place finish. He was one of approximately 5,100 participants in the Duke City Marathon.

Hart competed in the Duke City Marathon last year. Although it was his first time ever competing in a full marathon, Hart took third.

Hart was the only Aggie who participated in the men's marathon. Hart beat out two runners from UNM during the marathon on his way to first place.

"Winning the marathon was another way to stick it to the Lobos," Hart said.

Hart said he was able to pass the first-place runner with two miles left in the marathon to take possession of first place. Hart never gave up first place after taking it over.

"There is a lot more room to make up time in a marathon compared to an 8K," Hart said. "It makes it easier to make up time since a marathon is so much longer."

Michael Hart's brother James also competed in the Duke City Marathon by running the half marathon, finishing third overall with a time of 1:16:33.

Sophomore Liz Mata also competed in the Duke City Marathon, finishing with a time of 1:42:31 for third overall. Mata placed third overall in the 20-24 age group, becoming the highest-placing 20-year-old in the event.

All three Aggies participated in the event independently since the Duke City Marathon has no NCAA affiliation.

"I am insanely proud of these athletes," said assistant coach Meaghan Harkins. "I witnessed first-hand their hard work during the season and it is great to see their hard work come into fruition."

Cody Johnson is a contributing writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

The multi-purpose arena Pan American Center located at the top of NMSU.
Erynn McConnell / theRoundUp

Pan Am capacity downsizing

By Anthony Ruff | Staff Writer

The New Mexico State University Pan American Center on campus is decreasing seating capacity in hopes of increasing home court advantage at sporting events.

In previous seasons, the capacity of seats at the arena has been 12,516. The Pan Am's capacity this upcoming season will drop to 8,994 by covering up close to 3,000 seats. It is still unknown how they will cover up the seats.

"Reducing the capacity helps us create a better environment for our fans," NMSU marketing director Steve Macy said. "We have permanently closed the four upper corners of the arena to create a true home court advantage."

The Aggies have had problems selling out the arena for quite some time. Last season only 3,930 season tickets, about 25 percent, were bought and the crowds seemed sparse on many occasions.

Comparatively speaking, the University of New Mexico sells over 50 percent of the season tickets available. This season the fans will be packed in closer and hopefully much louder.

In January, Collegiate Consulting was hired by the university to gather data on a range of topics including market promotions, ticket pricing and seating schematics. Collegiate Consulting concluded the best step going forward would be a decrease in seating capacity.

"The environment is going to be a lot better this season," junior marketing major Tim Kellner said. "I never miss a home basketball game and would love to see the arena packed on a frequent basis."

The season ticket holder affected by the change have the option to purchase tickets in the upper middle section for just $2 more for the season. All ticket prices have been frozen through next season. Full-time students can still get into the game free.

There are no current plans to open up the covered seats for big games such as University of New Mexico and University of Texas at El Paso.

"It would be great if we could get enough fans to come out to the games and re-open those seats," Pan Am ticket manager Patrick Kennedy said. "We still need to be able to take the cover off for special events that draw large crowds."

The new seating arrangement is not the only change at the Pan American Center. For the first time since 1987, a new playing surface will be installed before the home opener on Nov. 19. This will be the third floor installed at the arena since opening in 1968. The estimated cost for installing the new floor is $175,000.

Anthony Ruff is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

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  Corbett Center Ballroom West 5:30 - 8:00pm
- 7 - Getting Hired with the Government
  Garcia Annex Rm. 207 4:00 - 5:00pm
- 8 - 11 - Resume Aggiemania: 10:00am -2:00pm
  Nov. 8 Gerald Thomas
  Nov. 9 Business Complex
  Nov. 10 & 11 Corbett Center
- 15 - Government & Public Service Career Fair
  Corbett Center 9:00am - 3:00pm
- 30 - Negotiating a Job Offer
  Garcia Annex Rm. 207 10:30 - 11:30am

December
- 6 -7 - Aggie Holiday Bash
  Dec. 6 O'Donnell Hall 10:00am - 1:00pm
  Dec. 7 Corbett Center 10:00am - 2:00pm

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Meet the Band: The Casual Fridays

By Jose Salayandia | Staff Writer

Ska is a musical genre that has been making a major impact on the music scene since about 1950. Local ska band The Casual Fridays is looking to make their impact on the Las Cruces scene with their modern take on the genre.

The Casual Fridays is made up of guitarist and vocalist Gabe Tena, bassist Matt Muniz, percussionist Andrew Anaya, trombonist Coleton Vitt, trumpeteer Paul Kimball and bass trombonist James McDaniel. The Casual Fridays incorporates soul, rock, punk and every wave of ska that that mixes in with their older songs.

While the band will play cover songs on occasion, they mostly enjoy playing original songs they have written themselves. The mixture of high energy beats and flowing music makes for a sound that almost any music fan can enjoy.

Vocalist and guitarist Gabe Tena said he tries not to overwhelm the listeners with anything he might feel to be unnecessary.

"The lyrics I write for the band are very simple. No symbolism or deep meaningful lyrics," Tena said. "I get right to the point by making short verses. The subjects range from love, break-ups, alley cats, Red Stripe beer, E.B.T, struggling relationships, people who are lazy, trying to be patient, being A.D.D, being falsely accused and how people don't return phone calls."

Ever since the band was formed, the band went through many lineup changes and had a wide variety of talent lending talent to the group's music. Despite the many changes in membership, Tena remained loyal to his creation and still remains the only original member of the group.

Vitt said he also has a pretty long history with the band.

"Gabe started the band in 2004 and is the only original member in the current lineup," Vitt said. "I heard about the band from his ex-girlfriend and met up with Gabe in 2006."

The Casual Fridays draws influence from many different musical styles mainly due to the fact that ska is a fusion genre in its own. Ska song mixes many musical genres in its roots including rap, reggae, rock and blues. Some may be surprised by the musical styles that influence the musician.

"Many bands have contributed to my style. Some of my favorites are Sublime, Led Zeppellin, John Mayer Trio, RHCP and many others," Anaya said. "I try to get something out of everything I listen to and every playing situation I am put in. All styles from classical to ska have had an influence in my playing."

The Casual Fridays plan on recording some new songs onto CD before heading on tour. The band has a lot of songs that have not been recording and would like to record these songs before heading out on the road. Once the recording is done, the band will continue planning a tour, which will include a stop at the Ska Brewing Company in Durango, Colo. Before that happens, they will be playing at Mikey's Place and De La Vegas Pecan Grill over the Halloween weekend.

For more information on The Casual Fridays, visit their Facebook and You Tube page. You can also download the band's new album, "Train To Skaville" for free at www.localcraprecords.com.

Jose Salayandia is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

heARTlines A Yarn Bombing Event

By Cherish Marquez | Staff Writer

Yarn bombing is coming to the New Mexico State University campus in the form of heARTlines, an event that is reaching out to the university and the community by using yarn.

heARTlines is a project hosted by assistant professor of modern & contemporary art history Stephanie Taylor who started the process of the project to bring awareness of the art program at NMSU.

"The plan is to 'bomb' the campus with knitted 'blood lines' that reach from the 'heart' of the art building to all areas of the university to illustrate the crucial role of the arts in any thriving university learning community," Taylor said.

Students, faculty and community members meet in knitting circles once a week to work on the project together and to raise strong ties with each other through the craft of knitting.

Currently, the project has attracted 78 volunteers, which includes community volunteers, NMSU faculty and staff and NMSU students.

Kally Malcom, a graduate fine arts student is participating in the project.

"I think it is great we have an opportunity to work collaboratively to bring attention to the art department," Malcom said.

Photography major Jessica Winsor, is also participating in this event to help the community and to put a focus on the art department.

"I am doing this to help Stephanie Taylor raise awareness for the art department and to help the community as well," Winsor said.

There has been 192 feet of "Aggie Red" yarn submitted. The goal is to reach one mile of yarn.

The project still needs 5,088 feet to be completed; the scheduled completion date is set to be Feb. 14, 2012.

"We will see a mile of knitted fabric unfurled from the art department to various buildings and sites around the NMSU campus," Taylor said.

The yarn bombing will not only be a part of NMSU, but aims to be a part of the community as well by connecting sites in the community to NMSU as a way to symbolize the connections with the community and NMSU.

The yarn bombing event heART line plans to bomb campus with a mile of Aggie red yarn. **Cherish Marquez/theRoundup**

After the project has fulfilled its goal to stretch across campus, professor Taylor plans to reuse and recycle the knitted yarn and give back to the community.

"By returning the knitted material to the community, the project will illustrate in real and tangible ways the arts can be used to raise awareness of community and draw our community together," Taylor said.

The material will be sewn into blankets and donated to various organizations around the city, such as local food banks, homeless shelters, children's day care centers and safe houses.

The next knitting circle will take place at the Barnes and Noble NMSU bookstore Oct. 31, 2011, from 4 p.m.-5 p.m. For questions on how to participate in heARTlines or for students simply interested in the project, contact Stephanie Taylor at sltaylor@nmsu.edu.

Cherish Marquez is a staff writer and can be reached at truprint@nmsu.edu

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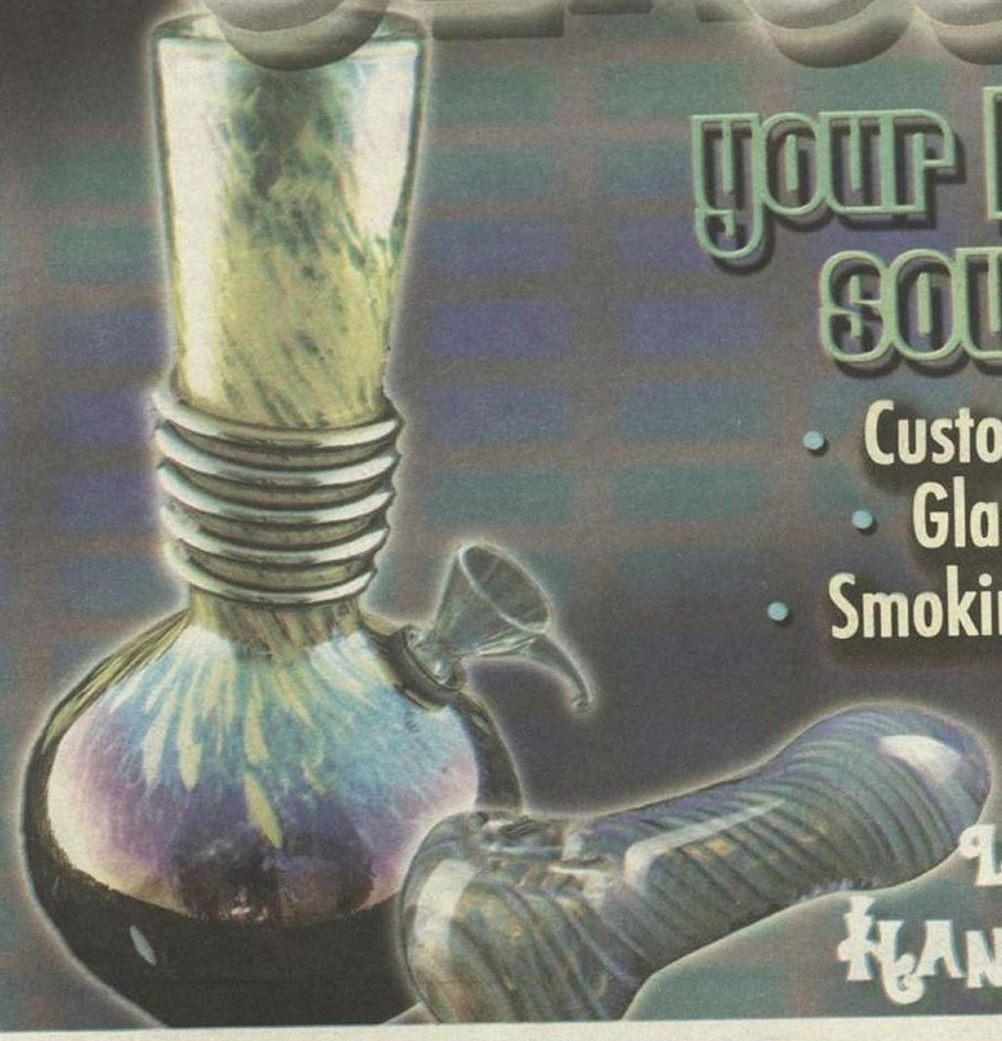

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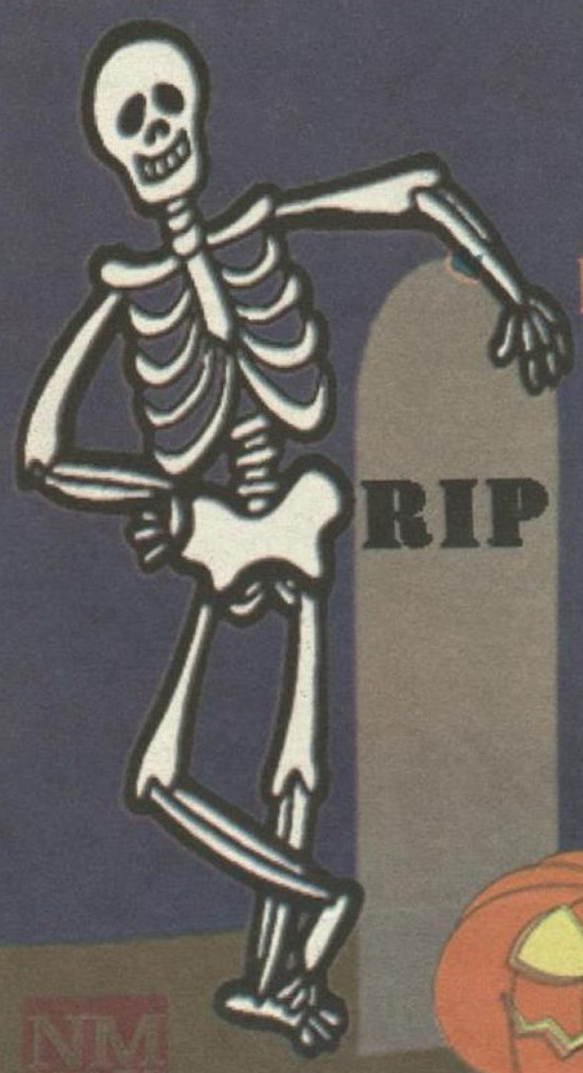

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